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Source: *Hesperia Supplements*, 1949, Vol. 8, Commemorative Studies in Honor of Theodore Leslie Shear (1949), pp. 324-340

Published by: The American School of Classical Studies at Athens

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THE ATHENIAN CURRENCY DECREE AND THE COINAGES OF THE ALLIES

I

THE discovery of a further portion of the decree by which Athens sought in the fifth century to regulate the currency circulating within her empire, and the evidence thus provided for fixing its date in the early forties, calls for a fresh examination of its problems. What was its scope and how far did it achieve its objects? It is an inquiry which we may think would have had a special interest for the distinguished archaeologist to whose memory this volume is dedicated. The new fragment, cut in Attic, not Ionic, writing, was unearthed in Cos and published by Segré, *Clara Rhodos*, IX, 1938, pp. 151 ff. He gives a detailed commentary with full references to previous literature, which there is therefore no need to repeat, and a text incorporating the earlier fragments from Smyrna, Siphnos, and Aphytis with much new restoration.[1] As he points out (pp. 167 ff.), the absence of Caria in the enumeration of the districts (para. 11 = p. 217, lines 30-33) implies a date either before 446 or after 438; and the style of the Attic lettering definitely calls for the earlier period. He shows some reason for regarding 449 as the most probable year. The purpose of the decree is twofold, as appears succinctly enough in the addition to the oath of the Bouleutai (para. 15 = p. 217, lines 42-48). It was to prevent: (i) the striking of *silver* coins in the cities; (ii) the use of currency, weights, and measures other than Athenian. Both objects would require not only immediate but also subsequent and more or less continuous action; and it may be doubted, in view of the sequel, whether the far-reaching implications of this policy, and especially of its drastic second clause, were fully grasped at the time of its promotion. First it should be noted that only silver coinage is affected. While Cyzicene staters of electrum figure in the totals of the first Treasury list of 454/3 and again with other gold coins in inscriptions recording payments after the Peace of Nikias, the carry forward in the building accounts unchanged from year to year between 447/6 and 433/2 of certain small sums of electrum staters unspent, might lend colour to the idea that their circulation was not recognized in the interval.[2] The decree however specifies *ἀργύριον* (para. 15 = p. 217, line 44),

[1] Reproduced by Meritt, Wade-Gery, and McGregor, *Athenian Tribute Lists*, p. 579, T69. I refer to it by the paragraphs into which it is there divided and by the lines of the composite text in *I.G.*, XII, Supplement (Berlin, 1939), pp. 216-217, the most recent publication.

It will be obvious that the discussion of the coinages of the allies which follows in the second section owes much to the previous work of Weil, Cavaignac, P. Gardner, and E. Babelon (cited by Segré, p. 171), though none of them has given a detailed survey of the coinages as a whole. I am also greatly indebted to Professor Meritt for many helpful suggestions towards the proposed restoration of the decree, to Professors Ashmole and Jacobsthal for long and patient discussion of the dating of individual issues, and especially to my colleague, H. Mattingly, for advice and criticism throughout.

[2] *A.T.L.*, p. 128; Tod, *Gk. Hist. Ins.*, p. 185, no. 75 (= *I.G.*, I², 302), line 13; and p. 112, no. 52 and note on p. 114.

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and there is no noticeable break in the electrum coinage of Cyzicus, Mytilene, or Phocaea which could be referred to such an embargo.[3]

The first object of the decree, to close the mints of the cities which up till now had issued coins, would be a comparatively straightforward operation. Among the lists which the Hellenotamiai must draw up under penalty (para. 1 = p. 216, lines 4-5) were perhaps lists of such mints, while the task of watching that they were not re-opened would most naturally fall among the duties laid upon the archons on the spot (paras. 3-4 = pp. 216 f., lines 9-15). But the second clause, to enforce the use of Athenian currency and prevent the use of any other, would be a much more complicated undertaking. In the first half of the fifth century the currency circulating within the area of the League must still have been of a very heterogeneous nature, with a preponderance, steadily diminishing, of non-Athenian money. Of this non-Athenian money a certain proportion will have originated outside the area, e. g., in lands subject to Persia, in Crete, Boeotia, etc., but the bulk must have been the product of local mints and above all of Aegina,—within the area, but till 457 not within the League. The mass of Aeginetan money still circulating was a continual reminder of Aegina's recent greatness, a continual irritation to Athens, and perhaps a considerable factor in promoting the decree. Here again not only short but long-term measures would be required to establish and maintain Athenian money as the exclusive silver currency of the area. First a time-limit must be set and meanwhile an immediate effort made, and on an enormous scale, to exchange or recoin the floating currency of non-Athenian into Athenian coins; then permanent regulations would be necessary for dealing in the same way with any subsequent non-Athenian money that might appear later from hoards within the area or by import from without. The coins of such states as were members of the League, must of course be melted down for re-coinage, but it might be more profitable to exchange and re-export the coins of non-members from outside. Unfortunately the fragmentary nature of the record still leaves us largely in the dark as to the exact terms of the decree and the details of its administration. Segré has bravely sought to elucidate some of them, especially by his restoration of the crucial passages in paras. 6-8 (= p. 217, lines 17-24), but several of his proposed readings seem open to the grave objections discussed below. Let us briefly summarize the points which directly touch the currency, leaving aside any questions of law, constitution, or finance in general. The Hellenotamiai are to draw up lists (of monies?, of cities that have been striking coins?). The archons in the cities, preferably Athenian, but, failing them, native, have also certain duties to carry out: perhaps to see that the mints are closed, and remain closed. It looks as if it was to be their task in addition to arrange for the collection of public monies held by the cities in non-Athenian currencies and for their transfer to Athens for recoinage. For immediately after the paragraph dealing with the penalties to be incurred by these officers if they fail in their duty, we find ourselves in the Mint at Athens (paras. 6-8).

[3] See further below in the review of the coinage of these cities, pp. 330-332.

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So far only the exchange of public money appears to be in question. After some paragraphs covering administration, etc., we pass in paras. 16-7 = p. 217, lines 48-55, to the exchange of money in private hands.

Segré restores the earlier and crucial passage (paras. 6-8 = p. 217, lines 17-20) as follows (I have lettered the lines A-H for convenience of reference):

A. ἐν δὲ τῶι] [4] ἀργυροκοπίωι τὸ ἀργύ[ριο
B. ν τὸ νῦν ὑπάρχον κόψασθαι μὴ ἔλ]αττον ἢ ἥμυσυ καὶ ἀ[πὸ
C. τούτου ὅσον οἱ ἄρχοντες καὶ αὐτα]ὶ αἱ πόλεις πράττ[ω
D. σι καταλλάττεν, διδόντας ἕκατον] δραχμὰς ἀπὸ τῆς μν
E. [ᾶς. τοὺς ἐπιστάτας τὸ ἀργύριον κατ]αλλάττεν ἢ ἐνόχο
F. [υς ἔναι κατὰ τὸν νόμον. ὃ δὲ ἂν περιγ]ίγνηται ἀργύριο
G. [ν, κόψασθαι μὲν αὐτίκα καὶ ἀποδίδο]σθαι ἢ τοῖς στρατ
H. [ηγοῖς ἢ κ.τ.λ.].

According to this, not less than half the existing bullion in the mint is to be coined and used to give in exchange, at the full rate of a hundred drachmas to the mina, for as much as the cities, acting either through Athenian archons or their own, require. The resulting non-Athenian money left in the mint is to be recoined and handed to the strategoi, etc. I venture, though without epigraphical competence, to point out certain objections to Segré's restorations and to suggest alternatives. The most important concerns the phrase in line D, --- δραχμὰς ἀπὸ τῆς μνᾶς which he rightly refers to the rate of exchange. But though he points out the analogy with the μνᾶ ἀπὸ τοῦ ταλάντου of the *aparchê*, he supplies ἕκατον for the missing number. Athens, he thinks, tried to recommend an unpopular measure to the allies by giving a highly favourable rate of exchange. They would receive weight for weight of bright new Athenian coins for any old silver turned in, without even deduction for the expenses of striking. A well-known passage in the *Poroi*,[5] though dealing with the fourth century, shows what a concession this might have been even in 449. But it is hardly in accordance with the temper of Athens at this time, or (may we add?) with its grammar. For surely ἀπὸ τῆς μνᾶς in this connexion cannot but imply a deduction. The local currencies to be tendered were by no means always of the high purity of the Athenian and in the circumstances a deduction of say three drachmas per mina to cover possible losses of this nature, and the expenses of recoining, does not seem unreasonable. The preceding lacuna will then have contained some formula expressing this deduction; and it is possible, and much more appropriate, to complete the verb πρατ --- in the preceding line C in this sense instead of so as to describe the requirements of the cities. The tone of πράττειν belongs to the suzerain rather than to the subject. Working still further back we come in line A to the mention of certain ἀργύριον, not less than half of which is in some way to be dealt with. Segré has worked this up into an

[4] τῶ]ι, *I.G.*, XII, Supplement, p. 217, line 17.

[5] Καὶ οἱ ἀργύριον ἐξάγοντες καλὴν ἐμπορίαν ἐξάγουσιν, ὅπου γὰρ ἂν πωλῶσιν αὐτὸ πανταχοῦ πλεῖον ἢ τοῦ ἀρχαίου λαμβάνουσι, [Xenophon], *Poroi*, III, 2.

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elaborate provision to ensure quick exchange of money brought in: elaborate and unnecessary. There is no reason to suppose that the epistatai kept large stores of bullion uncoined in the mint. Why should they? Anyhow, to coin any bullion that might be in hand to meet an expected emergency is surely too obvious a precaution to be specially prescribed; and even if not, why "not less than half"? Should we not rather give *ἀργύριον* here its natural reference to the monies of the cities to be brought in for exchange? I suggest the procedure was as follows: The public monies that have been collected and transferred to Athens on behalf of the cities are to be exchanged at the mint there, weight for weight, less say 3%, into Athenian currency; not less than half as soon as possible so as to provide for their immediate needs, and the remaining half within a fixed period. Any sums not already dealt with are to be recoined and paid out to the strategoi, etc. This last provision would dispose of the 3% deducted for expenses. The passage might then run *exempli gratia* something as follows:

A. *ἐν δὲ τῶ]ι ἀργυροκοπίωι τὸ ἀργύ[ριο*
B. *ν δεξαμένους εὐθὺς κόψαι μὴ ἔλ]αττον ἢ ἥμυσυ καὶ ἀ]πο*
C. *δόσθαι ὡς ἂν νόμισμα ἱκανὸν ἔχωσ]ι αἱ πόλεις. πράττ[ε*
D. *σθαι δὲ αἰεὶ ἐπικαταλλαγὴν τρῆς] δραχμὰς ἀπὸ τῆς μν*
E. *[ᾶς· τὸ δὲ ἄλλο ἥμυσυ πέντε μηνῶν κατ]αλλάττεν ἢ ἐνόχο*
F. *[υς ἶναι κατὰ τὸν νόμον, ὃ δὲ ἂν περιγ]ίγνηται ἀργυρίο*
G. *[υ τοῦ πεπραγμένου κόψαι καὶ ἀποδό]σθαι ἢ τοῖς στρατ*
H. *[ηγοῖς ἢ κ. τ. λ. ---]*

Line A. Here where the context requires it and also later (paras. 13 and 17 = p. 217, lines 39 and 51) I take *ἀργυροκόπιον* to refer to the Mint at Athens, for (1) in both the latter cases it is mentioned in conjunction with *ἐπιστάται*, which we know to have been the name of the mint officials at Athens and by no means necessarily elsewhere: (2) by no means all the cities appear to have possessed mints of their own at any time: see the lists in the next section: (3) though para. 13, which lays down that the decree is to be set up "in the agora of each city and in front of the Mint" might at first sight suggest the local mint, is it likely that two copies of the same inscription would be set up in the same city? (4) If this were really so there would be no visible provision for setting up the decree in Athens at all.

Line B. The Cos and Aphytis fragments overlap at this point and the text of the former is slightly shorter, leaving a gap of sixteen letters between the certain end of *ἀργύ[ριον* and beginning of *μὴ ἔλ]αττον. δεχσαμένος κόφσαι*, omitting *εὐθύς*, would fill it. Segré restores here and in line G the middle *κόψασθαι*. The stone (para. 15 = p. 217, line 44) prefers the active in this context and I have put it back.

Line D. Some word such as *ἐπικαταλλαγή* (for which cf. Theophrastus, *Charact.*, XXX, 15) would fit the context, but it is not essential and it might perhaps be better to bring in the epistatai here, e. g., *πράττ[εσθαι δὲ τοὺς ἐπιστάτας αἰεὶ τρῆς] δραχμὰς κ. τ. λ.*

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Line E. A longer period would be possible.

Line G. The final transaction has been restored to cover the 3% deduction only, the second half of the monies transmitted for exchange being dealt with in line E, but it might also have included an amount equal to the Athenian currency held in the mint at the beginning of the operation. For the active κόψαι, see above, note on line B.

The following sections (paras. 9-15 = p. 217, lines 24-48) contain nothing relevant to this particular inquiry, except the addition to the oath of the Boule already mentioned, the gist of which is clear and certain. With clause 16 we pass apparently to the exchange of money in private hands, but here again the stone becomes too fragmentary to inform us of the procedure in detail. The text as originally restored is quite unreliable, and I understand that a new version is soon to be published by Meritt, Wade-Gery, and McGregor in the second volume of their *Athenian Tribute Lists.*

So much for the strictly monetary terms of the decree as far as we can make them out. How did they work out in practice? Were the mints in fact closed, and was Athenian currency in fact substituted for the various local currencies? In the remainder of this article I propose to try to answer the first question by examining the fifth-century coinages of the *archê* district by district, and to collect what little evidence there may be bearing upon the second.

II

The tables which follow contain, district by district, lists of the cities in the *archê* which coined during the fifth century. The interval between Mykale and Aigospotamoi is divided into fifteen-year periods with a column to each period, and a further column at either end; and in each column is recorded the nature of the coinage, if any, issued. A stroke (—) indicates small change only; a cross (+) that larger pieces were issued as well. Where gold or electrum [6] was issued, this has been noted; otherwise all coinage is of silver. Doubling of the sign means a specially abundant coinage. Occasional dates have been inserted in the columns within the periods: when such a date precedes the sign, it means the beginning of a coinage; when it follows the sign, its end. Thus 432 + denotes the beginning of the Chalcidian coinage at Olynthos, + + 457 the end of the coinage at Aegina. Dating has necessarily rested almost entirely on style, and, though with the development of Attic art to help us, this perhaps involves less uncertainty in the second half of the fifth century than at most other times, few dates would not admit a shift of some years either way. After each district I have added a few notes and references on doubtful points, particularly where I diverge from the current view.

[6] The early electrum coinages not continued into the 5th century and that of the Ionian revolt have been omitted as their attribution to individual cities is usually quite uncertain and in any case they are hardly relevant to the present inquiry.

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Islands	Before Mykale	479-465	465-450	450-435	435-420	420-405	4th. cent.
Aegina	++	++	++ 457				++
Andros	+						+
Chalkis	++ *						+
Delos	+ *	+ *	+ *				+
Eretria	++ *	+ *				411 +	+
Iulis	+	+					
Karthaia	+	+	+				
Karystos	+ *	+ *					+
Koresia	+	+	+				
Melos	+	+	+	+	+	+ 416	+
Naxos	+						+
Paros	++	+	— *				+
Seriphos	+						
Siphnos	+	+	— *				+
Tenos	+						+
Thera	+						

* denotes Euboïc standard.

Andros. E. Babelon, *Traité des Mon. Gr.*, LX, 1; other and to me less likely attributions are to Keos, Imhoof-Blumer, *Gr. Münz.*, p. 13, 22, and to Athens by Seltman, *Athens*, p. 7.

Caria	Before Mykale	479-465	465-450	450-435	435-420	420-405	4th. cent.
Aspendos	+	++	++	++	++	++	++
Astypalaia		+					+
Chersonesos	+						
Halikarnassos		—	—				—
Ialysos	+	+	—			— * 407	
Iasos	+						+
Idyma						+	+
Kalymna	+						+
Kamiros	+	+	—			— 407	
Karpathos	+						
Kaunos	+ ?						—
Kelenderis			+	+	+	+	+
Knidos	++	++	++			412 +	++
Kos	+			+ *	+ *	?	+
Lindos	+	+	—			— * 407	
Lykia	++	++	++	++	++	++	++
Phaselis	+	+	+				+
Rhodes						407 + *	++
Termera	+						
Uncertain, Mylasa?	+	+					+
" Karo-Lykian		+	+	+	+	+	+

* denotes Euboïc standard.

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ASTYPALAIA. *Traité*, XIX, 5-7. These coins reading 'Αστ(υ) are usually attributed to the Carian Astyra, but this Astyra does not occur in the tribute lists as might have been expected if it were of sufficient importance to strike money. The fifth-century coinage is on the same standard (" Babylonian ") as neighboring Kalymna. That of the fourth century (*Tr.*, CXLV, 7-12) is equally appropriate to Astypalaia and follows Rhodes.

HALIKARNASSOS. At the time of the Lygdamis inscription (Dittenberger[3], no. 45, just before mid-century) staters and twelfths were current: this can only mean Cyzicene electrum. B. Keil (*Hermes*, XXIX, p. 256) has concluded that silver of the Persian standard (which he calls " Babylonian ") was in use then, and continued until the change of standard recorded in a later inscription (Dittenberger[3], no. 46). A coin of siglos standard (*Tr.*, CXLVI, 15) shows this to be correct, though his premise is faulty, for there is no immediate relation between the weight of the electrum and the silver. Another drachma of this period but of Aeginetic weight alleged by Babelon to be of Halikarnassos (*Tr.*, XVIII, 8) is rather of Knidos. In the fourth century, the standard is certainly Rhodian, a standard which did not come into use in this quarter of the Aegean till about 400. If, then, the inscription recording the change is as early as Dittenberger thinks, the change must have been to Euboïc-Attic, followed later by another change to Rhodian. This is not impossible, *pace* Keil, for we find the same standard about this time at Rhodes and Cos. The usual dating of the inscription, however, which Keil adopts, towards the end of the fifth century or later, permits us to regard the change as one from Persian weight to Rhodian (according to Keil, " Phoenician ").

IONIA, etc.	Before Mykale	479-465	465-450	450-435	435-420	420-405	4th. cent.
Assos			—				+
Chios	+ +	+	+ +	+ El +	+	+ +	+ +
Ephesos	+	+	+			N +	+ +
						Æ + +	
Erythrai	+	+					+
Gargara					—	—	—
Klazomenai	+	—	—				+ *
Kolophon	+	+	+		430? +	+	+
Kyme	+	—	—			412 +	—
Miletos	— —	— —	—	— ?	— ?	— — *	+ *
Phokaia	El + —	El — —	El — —	El — —	El — —	El — —	El — —
	Æ —						
Samos	+ +	+ +	+	+	+ +	+ +	+ +
Teos	+	+	+	+	+	+	+

* denotes Euboïc standard.

EPHESOS. The stylised type makes the dating of this coinage peculiarly hard. The defection of the city in the teens was followed by a plentiful silver coinage with

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some gold staters of daric weight. Head (*Coinage of Ephesus*, p. 20) also places a scanty coinage of Samian standard between 450 and 415, but this is quite uncertain and a date either just before or just after those limits would be equally possible for it.

KOLOPHON. The standard is Persian. J. G. Milne in his detailed study of this mint (*Num. Notes & Mon.*, no. 96) ranges the coinage in groups spread more or less evenly over the century, his group C ending about 450. His groups F and G, however (for which compare the latest coins of Leontini, *ca.* 425), seem rather to precede than to follow D and E (for which compare still later heads at Catana). It looks like a stop at *ca.* 450 (after the reorganization of *I.G.*, I², 14-15?) and a resumption after the revolt of 430.

KYME. The drachma (*Tr.*, CLVII, 9), which I put to the revolt of 412, is usually dated later, in the fourth century. It is however of Aeginetic weight like the contemporary coins of Teos which abandons Aeginetic for Rhodian weight in the fourth century.

MILETOS has only small change in the fifth century. Head (*B.M.C. Ionia*, p. 185) calls the little pieces Attic diobols and dates them all after Mykale. They seem rather to be twelfths of the Milesian stater and to begin in the sixth century (cf. the hoard Egypt 362: Noe, *Num. Notes & Mon.*, no. 78), thinning out, if not disappearing, in the third quarter of the fifth century, and resuming at its end, at a weight now approximately that of an Attic trihemiobol, to be followed some years later by Attic hemidrachms (*B.M.C.*, *ibid.*, nos. 12-13) and the pieces struck for Hekatomnos and Maussolos on the same standard (*ibid.*, nos. 36 ff.).

SAMOS. The rare tetradrachms of Attic weight (*Tr.*, CL, 26) are shown by style and the use of monograms to be the immediate precursors of the series of Rhodian weight which begins about 400 (*Tr.*, CLI, 4-10): they belong therefore not to the period just after the revolt but to the very end of the war, the period of the sympolity. There is a marked break in style and fabric between them and their predecessors, the series lettered from B-Ξ. In this gap of ten years or so falls a unique tetradrachm with Athenian types and ethnic, but Samian symbol (Seltman, *Greek Coins*, pl. XXX, 4), which reflects the conditions of 411. The lettered series has fifteen varieties as well as one or two more, unlettered, on the same pattern. Whatever the precise significance of the letters it is not unreasonable to regard each issue as being that of a year. This takes us back to 430, if not earlier, so that coinage must have been resumed surprisingly soon after the crushing of the revolt.

LESBOS AND THE AKTE	Before Mykale	479-465	465-450	450-435	435-420		420-405	4th. cent.
Methymna	+ *				+			+
Mytilene	El — —	El — —	El — —	El — —	El — —	427		El — —
	Æ +	Æ +	Æ —	Æ —	Æ —			AR +
Antandros			+				—	—
Pordosilene					427 — *			

* denotes Euboïc standard.

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METHYMNA. The isolated issue on the Samian standard (*Tr.*, CLXII, 28-33) *might* be after the revolt of 412, but looks earlier. I suggest the time of the revolt of Mytilene, when Methymna remained loyal, for the Athena head is very Attic and has a crescent on the helmet. Cf. the relief of Athena on the decree of *ca.* 427 for Mytilene (*I.G.*, I², 60; *A.M.*, XXXV, p. 12).

MYTILENE. The electrum coinage falls into two parts, the earlier with incuse reverse type, the later with reverse type in relief. There is a definite break between the two which falls well on in the second half of the century. Occasional bullion or silver issues go down to the same point, which can only be the reduction of the city in 427. The unique electrum stater (*Tr.*, CLIX, 1: all the other electrum coins are hektai) with head of Apollo Maloeis? is of this date. The later electrum coinage is resumed about the time of Aigospotamoi if not before. Was this resumption the occasion of the monetary convention with Phokaia (Collitz, *Dialekt-Inschr.*, I, p. 83)?

ANTANDROS. (*Tr.*, CLXIII, 2-7). Persian standard: the resumption was presumably after 412, and in connexion with the shipbuilding carried on here by Sparta and her allies (Xenophon, *Hell.*, I, 1, 25, etc.).

PORDOSILENE. (*Tr.*, CLXII, 44), a single issue on the Euboic-Attic standard, which by its style, should have been struck immediately on the liberation from Mytilene in 427 rather than after 412.

HELLESPONT	Before Mykale	479-465	465-450	450-435	435-420	420-405	4th. cent.
Abydos	—	—	—			411 Ꞡ +	+
Astakos			+	*ca.* 440 +			
Byzantion						Iron —	+
Chersonesos	+	—	—			—	—
Dardanos			+				—
Kalchedon		— *	— *		— *		+
Kebren	+	—	—		— ?		—
Kyzikos	El + +	El + +	El + +	El + +	El + +	El + +	El + +
	Æ +	Æ —	Æ —	Æ —	Æ —	Æ —	Æ + +
Lampsakos	El +	El +	El +				Ꞡ +
	Æ +	Æ —	Æ —			Æ —	Æ —
Neandria						—	—
Parion	—	—					—
Prokonnesos						—	—
Selymbria		—	—			411 —	
Skepsis		+	+				—
Tenedos	+						+

* denotes Euboïc standard.

ASTAKOS. The date of the later issue (*Tr.*, CLXXXI, 4-6) can be fixed by comparison with the similar nymph's head in sakkos at Syracuse (Boehringer, *Syrakus*,

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pls. 26 and 27, "450-439 B.C."). It must belong to the period between the "absence from full panel" of the Tribute list of 443 (*A.T.L.*, p. 238) and the Athenian colonisation of 435/4.

BYZANTION. Silver coinage on the Persian standard and model, in conjunction with Kalchedon, does not appear to have begun here till after Aigospotamoi. Small change was previously provided by a purely local currency of iron (Aristophanes, *Clouds*, 249, and schol.; Pollux, IX, 78; Hesychius Σιδάρεοι Θεοί).

DARDANOS. I cannot follow the interpretation adopted by Babelon of the rider type (*Tr.*, CLXVII, 17-19) as Mania, wife of Zenis, with its consequent dating. The figure is male and the date mid-century (*B.M.C. Troas*, p. xlii).

KYZIKOS. The electrum coinage runs without obvious break throughout the fifth century and reflects in due course the Parthenon and subsequent styles, some types, especially in the last quarter (Erichthonios, Gaia, the Tyrannicides), bearing special reference to Athens. The silver (small change only) thins out considerably after 450.

THRACE, etc.	Before Mykale	479-465	465-450	450-435	435-420	420-405	4th. cent.
Abdera	+ +	+ +	+ +	+ +	+ +	+ +	+ +
Aineia	+ *			—	—		—
Ainos		+ + *	+ + *		+ + *	+ + *	+ +
Akanthos	+ + *	+ + *	+ *	+ *	+ *	+	+
Aphytis				*ca.* 440 — *	— *	— *	—
Dikaia (of the Eretrians)	+ *	+ *	— *		*ca.* 430 — *		—
Dikaia (by Abdera)	+	+					
Kapsa (Skapsa)			— *				
Kithai (Skithai)	+ *						
Maroneia	+	+	+	+ +	+ +	+ +	+ +
Mende	+ + *	+ + *	+ *	*ca.* 440 + *	+ *	+ *	+
Neapolis (by Antisara)	+	+	+	—	— —	— —	— —
Olynthos (Chalcidians)		— *			*ca.* 430 + +	+ +	+ +
Olynthos					*ca.* 432? —		
Peparethos	+ *						—
Potideia	+ *	+ *	—				—
Samothrace	+ *	—					+
Sermylia	+ *	+ *					
Skione	+ *	— *	— *		424? —		—
Skyros	+ *	+ * *ca.* 470					
Stageira	+ *	+ *	+ *				
Terone	+ *	+ *	—		424? —		—
Thasos	+ +	+ + 464			+	+ ; 411 *N* —	+ +
Tinde?	+						

* denotes Euboïc standard.

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AINEIA has two isolated issues of small change in the fifth century, no longer Euboïc but probably of the "Babylonian" standard of Thasos. The first (Gaebler, *Ant. Münz. Nord-Gr.*, III, 2, Taf. V, 37) by its style, goes most comfortably after 450, though it might be just before; the second (*ibid.*, Taf. V, 38 and VI, 2) is so close in types and style to early issues of Thurium as to be easily confused with them; therefore round about 430.

AINOS. (Strack, *ibid.*, II, 1, 128). I adopt the dating of Mr. J. F. May, whose study of this mint will appear shortly and who has kindly discussed his results with me. The first issue ends with the tetradrachm of Antiadas (*ibid.*, Taf. IV, 11) about 450; there is then a break, and resumption, with small change only, about 435. This is augmented a few years later by a steady issue of tetradrachms going over into the fourth century.

AKANTHOS. Euboïc staters were struck without obvious interruption from Mykale down to the thirties, if not beyond, and pass smoothly into the "Phoenician" staters of the next period. The later Euboïc staters (which are inscribed) bear symbols (*ibid.*, III, 2, Taf. VII, 1-5) and show analogies with the Parthenon frieze. With these go sixths often so light in weight that they might be taken for tetrobols of the following period (as in fact they are by Gaebler, *loc. cit.*) were it not for the correspondence of the symbols. Other small change shows, like that of Aineia, striking analogies to early Thurium; therefore, again round about 430.

APHYTIS. Occasional small change, but Gaebler's date for the earliest (*ibid.*, p. 44), 450, is a decade or more too early, as comparison with the Antiadas tetradrachm of Ainos shows (*ibid.*, II, 1, Taf. IV, 11). Also the standard is Euboïc, not Phoenician as he states.

DIKAIA of the Eretrians. The latest issue, *ca.* 430 (*Tr.*, CCCXL, 1-4) is currently given to the other Dikaia, by Abdera, but the type is more appropriate here (a nymph's head and bull appear in conjunction on fourth-century bronze, *Tr.*, CCCXII, 14) while the standard is Euboïc, native in this city, unknown in the other. For the dating compare the contemporary heads at Thasos and Neapolis by Antisara (*Tr.*, CCCXXII, 2-3, and CCCXXIV, 4-6).

MENDE. Our knowledge of this mint is mostly derived from the Kaliandra hoard published by Noe, *Num. Notes & Mon.*, no. 27, and also discussed by Regling, *Z.f.N.*, XXXIV, p. 11. Gaebler's treatment of the series (*op. cit.*, p. 72) is vitiated by his erroneous belief that the greater part of the hoard consisted of forgeries. Regling (*loc. cit.*) gives a methodical arrangement of the varying types which though logical does not fit the facts of the die-couplings as revealed in Noe's study and must therefore be disregarded. The coinage falls into two groups, with, and without, reverse type. Both are represented in the hoard. This was almost certainly buried during the siege of 423 and shows that the bulk of the coinage of Euboïc weight was already struck by that time, a considerable proportion quite recently before. The style is uneven, but

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analogies with Parthenon sculpture abound on the fine pieces. There is general agreement that the earlier series with the donkey and incuse reverse comes to an end about mid-century; and it is usually thought to pass straight into the later series with Dionysos and vinestock. This view is really based on the crudeness and rough style of the pieces placed at the head of the series. It is clear however from a glance at Noe's plates that these characteristics are to be found not only on the earlier pieces but also on others which are linked typologically with some of the latest and finest in the hoard. Further the change from the reverse with incuse only to the reverse with full type is abrupt: there is no transitional stage as at Akanthos or Abdera where the ethnic appears first in the incuse without accompanying type. Finally the ethnic itself changes between the two issues; on the earlier it is **Μινδαίον**, on the later invariably **Μενδαίον**. I have accordingly assumed a gap of ten years or more between the end of the first and the beginning of the second issue.

NEAPOLIS by Antisara. For the dating of the abundant coinage of the twenties, see Gaebler, *Ant. Münz. Nord-Gr.*, III, 2, p. 80, and compare contemporary heads at Dikaia of the Eretrians and Thasos. Gaebler (*loc. cit.*) ends the earlier coinage with incuse reverse in mid-century, but half-staters on the Thasian pattern sometimes with an initial appear later on, probably in the thirties.

OLYNTHOS. The issues of this mint bear two inscriptions: the scarce first issue and the abundant later ones **Χαλκ. Χαλκιδέων**, the scarce intermediate ones **Ολυν**. (See Robinson and Clement, *Excav. at Olynthus*, IX, for the coins in general, and *ibid.*, pl. XXXIV, for the issues before 432). The later coinage with **Χαλκιδέων** on the "Phoenician" standard begins soon after 432 and carries on till the destruction of the city by Philip: the earlier, on the Euboïc standard, soon after the city was handed over by Artabazos to the Chalcidian "clan." The series inscribed **Ολυν**, though of the same types as the earlier issue, is struck on the standard of the later, and largely for this reason has been taken to be after the revolt of 433/2. This is not conclusive. This standard is by no means the sign of rebellion that it is sometimes held to be, for it occurs e. g. at Aineia ten to twenty years earlier, and on style the issue might have been made ten years earlier.

SAMOTHRACE. The coins of this island have only recently been identified by Schwabacher (*Trans. Int. Num. Congress*, 1936, p. 109) and most of our knowledge of them comes from the Kiourpet hoard, buried about 470, which he there describes.

SKYROS. (*Tr.*, CCCII, 18-27). These coins have been condemned en bloc as modern forgeries; some at any rate (e. g., no. 18) appear to me to be genuine.

THASOS. See A. B. West, *Num. Notes & Mon., no. 40*, p. 10, for a full study. I would begin the gold and the silver of "Phoenician" standard, with the new types, after Aigospotamoi [7] rather than after the revolt of 411, as he does. To the latter,

[7] Cf. *Num. Chron.*, 1934, p. 253.

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however, may belong some scanty gold and silver small change (*Tr.*, CCCXXII, 10-12, etc.). Otherwise after a break which should coincide with the first revolt, there is a resumption from the thirties onwards with pieces reflecting Parthenon style, and having a maximum density in the twenties.

TINDE. The " Babylonian " stater inscribed **Τυντενον** (*Tr.*, XLIX, 14) strongly suggests the **Τινδαῖοι** of the Tribute lists (*A.T.L.*, p. 555) and comes from the same area.

EUXINE	Mykale	479-465	465-450	450-435	435-420	420-405	4th. cent.
Apollonia Pontica			—*	—*	—*	—*	+
Apollonia-Pantikapaion			+	+?	+?	+	++
Nymphaion						+	
Sinope	+	+	+	+ 440?		++	++

* denotes Euboïc standard.

APOLLONIA PONTICA has a continuous coinage on a light and falling Euboïc standard as at Ainos. Is this really the Apollonia of the tribute lists (*A.T.L.*, p. 469)? See next note.

APOLLONIA-PANTIKAPAION. Pantikapaion, like Amisos-Peiraeus across the water, appears to have borne an alternative name in the later fifth century, for the first coinage actually to be inscribed **Παν** (" Babylonian " standard, *ca.* 400, *Tr.*, CCCLIII, 5-12) is immediately preceded by another, slightly earlier in style, but identical in type, fabric, and weight, either inscribed **Απολ** (*ibid.*, nos. 2-4), or, earlier still, without ethnic (*ibid.*, XVII, 9-16). May not this, rather than Pontica, be the Apollonia of the ninth assessment, which seems to omit other cities of the East Euxine coast, e. g., Mesembria and Kallatis, but to include several Crimean ones—Nymphaion, Patrasys, etc.?

What picture do the tables yield us? In the Island district the course of the coinage is clear enough. With two exceptions output slackens after Mykale, till in mid-century it stops completely. The exceptions are Aegina which rather intensified her coinage in the second quarter, and just before the end, in 457, was actually experimenting with a reverse type instead of the incuse, and Melos which carried on undiminished till 416. Apart from the Euboean cities and Delos which use the Euboïc standard, and Melos, which has the so-called Phoenician, the prevailing standard is Aeginetic, at Paros and Siphnos the smaller pieces being perhaps modified at the end into Euboïc-Attic. Towards the end of the century Eretria resumes coinage in the name of the Euboeans, no longer on the native Euboic, but on the Aeginetic standard which prevailed throughout Boeotia and the Peloponnese. This can only be the immediate result of the rebellion of 411.

In the Karian district things are much about the same, with a couple of exceptions to be discussed later: only at Aspendos and Kelenderis, and in Lykia and up-country

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Karia—i. e., on the outskirts of the empire and where Athenian writs did not really run—was coinage freely issued throughout the second half of the century. The resumption at Knidos must, like that at Eretria, be the immediate result of the revolt in 412, for the style of her coins is very close to that of the earliest issues of Rhodes after the synoecism (cf. *Tr.*, CXLV, 15, 17-18, with CXLVII, 20-22), and in the interim the cities of Rhodes appear to have followed her. It may be even that some of their small change which, like the earliest federal issue, is assimilated to the Attic standard, was issued earlier. Kos provides us with the first serious problem. Here (*Traité*, CXLVIII, 9-13) beginning about 450 was struck a sparse series of tetradrachms of Attic weight, perhaps in connexion with a local agonistic festival [8] which, though they show no great progress to late fifth-century style in the athlete of the obverse, to judge by the development of their reverses must have continued down to 420 or even later. Segré has justly pointed out (p. 172) that the fragmentary copy of the decree recently found in Kos was cut in Athens and so presumably set up in the island by Athenian officials in accordance with the terms of para. 14, because the local authorities had failed in their duty to do so. It looks, therefore, as if, in the beginning at any rate, the Koans had deliberately flouted the ban on coining, though later, like some Thracian cities which we shall meet, they may have obtained a concession.

In the remaining districts the picture is less clear. Electrum coinage indeed, which is native to N. W. Asia Minor, is only to be expected, for its function was to supplement the silver currency, and it was by implication excluded from the scope of the decree. Nor is it perhaps very surprising to find the coinages of the major, ship-providing allies, Chios, Lesbos, Samos, continued after, as before, 450; nor cities in revolt reopening their mints, as did Abydos, Kolophon, and Olynthos, and perhaps Skione and Terone. Even occasional and scanty issues of small change obviously for local use, as, may be, at Aineia, Kalchedon, Dikaia, Gargara, Miletos, etc., might be winked at.

What does require explanation is the steady and not inconsiderable coinage which was put out by a few towns principally in Thrace, but also in Asia Minor, in the second half of the century. This was most abundant from, say, the outbreak of hostilities in 432 onwards, and some of it may have been due to war conditions, for example at Methymna or Pordosilene during the revolt of Mytilene; or it may have been convenient to the Athenians during the campaigns of Brasidas to allow the mints of Mende and Thasos to meet sudden and urgent needs for currency which could not be conveniently supplied from Athens. But in general these coinages, though most abundant in the twenties, appear either to have carried right through without a break from the first half of the century (Teos, Abdera, Akanthos, Maroneia) or, more often, to have resumed again about 440 or soon after (Ainos, Aphytis, Mende,

[8] Not the Triopian, Herodotus, I, 144, for which Knidos would be the obvious mint.

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Neapolis, Thasos). It may even be that a closer study, by dies, of those mints which appear to carry through, would reveal a break in the forties such as I have concluded here for Mende and Ainos, where also up until now, coinage had been held to be continuous.

The point, in any case, is that whereas there was a sudden and practically universal stoppage during the forties, by the thirties certain cities were coining again freely and their coinage was tolerated, even, perhaps, as at Mende, encouraged. One of the most remarkable cases is that of Samos where very soon after the crushing of the revolt in 439 the mint was busy again issuing tetradrachms not only of the old types but on the old local standard. About the same time the coinage of Thasos which had ceased after the revolt in 464 is similarly resumed on the old pattern. It looks as if after (perhaps as a result of) the Samian revolt Athens somewhat modified her currency policy and restored or confirmed their individual right of coinage to a certain number of cities, most of them lying near the important sources of silver in Thrace.[9]

But, to sum up, apart from such limited concessions, and apart from the free coinage of electrum, from occasional issues of small change and from the more important issues of nominal allies on the fringes of the empire, the ban on coinage within the *archê* between 450 and the last decade of the century was complete. How complete indeed can be seen by contrast. As the Peloponnesian War drew to a close, and city and city revolted, still more in the early fourth century, there is a sudden outburst of coinage up and down the shores of the Aegean, and particularly on its northern and eastern coasts, of remarkable richness and variety.

The conclusion that from the forties onwards, at least, the ban on coinage, though general, was not absolute, provides an automatic answer to our further question. Athens was *not* successful in forcing the exclusive use either of her standard or her coins on the allies, and the attempt seems to have been tacitly abandoned. Aristophanes' joke in 414 [10] about the decrees of Cloud-cuckoo-land need have no more significance than might a reference nowadays in an English pantomime to the periodically revived project for an English decimal coinage, which is still in abeyance though the first abortive step to it was taken a century ago.

[9] Cf. the provision in the second decree for Methone (Tod, *op. cit.*, no. 61, lines 41-47) exempting the city from general decrees affecting the allies unless specifically named. This presumably would have given her the right to open a mint though she does not seem to have profited by it. Meritt has suggested that the right of coinage might have been restored to certain cities by a decree of the late twenties (*Hesperia*, XIV, p. 120), but this is too late for most of the cases under consideration.

[10] *Birds*, 1040, with Cobet's and Bergk's emendations. Like our decree, Aristophanes speaks in the same breath of *μέτροισι καὶ σταθμοῖσι καὶ νομίσμασιν*. The first two are outside the scope of the present article nor do I know of any certain evidence bearing on them, but the revised dating of the decree brings fresh support to the view that the metric relief of just before 450 at Oxford, certainly from within the *archê* and perhaps from Samos (*J.H.S.*, 1883, p. 335, pl. XXXV), belongs in this connexion, especially if Michaelis is right in his suggestion that the Attic foot has been subsequently engraved alongside the embodied Samian fathom.

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A glance at the tables above shows that the use of the Attic standard was far from general among those allies who coined in the second half of the century. True it appears to have spread for a while, as we have seen, in an area in S. W. Asia Minor, embracing Rhodes, Cos, perhaps Halikarnassos and other cities, where it survived into the fourth century at Miletos and Klazomenai; and when Tissaphernes engaged himself to support the Peloponnesian fleet in this quarter the terms were arranged in Attic drachmae.[11] On the other hand, further north in Chios payments for the same purpose were made in the local currency, expressed in terms of the Aeginetic mina, the normal unit of the Peloponnese [12] and the contribution of certain philo-Lakonian Chians to the Spartan war-chest during the Peloponnesian war was also paid in Aeginetan staters (*I.G.*, V, 1, no. 1, line 9). In the Thraceward district also the native standards of the coinages still tolerated were not interfered with. True that for many, though by no means all, of these, this standard was already a form of Euboïc; but it was often irregular in weight and sometimes, as at Ainos, deliberately light. By Gresham's law bad money drives out the good, and such staters, circulating side by side with good Athenian tetradrachms can only have been a nuisance. But they were left alone. At Samos (and Thasos), as we have seen, coinage was actually permitted in the old non-Athenian standard even after the rebellion.

As for Athenian coins taking the place of the existing currency in general circulation in the cities, what evidence there is goes to show that such a result was never in sight, even before the Dekeleian War brought the familiar silver issues to an end and replaced them by gold and token bronze. If the calling in and recoining of non-Athenian currencies envisaged in the decree had been seriously carried through, we should hardly have expected the lists which we find in the Treasury accounts of the Other Gods (*I.G.*, I², 310, of 429/8), containing such entries as Aeginetan staters, Chian didrachms, silver of Akanthos (lines 110 ff.) and *ξενικὸν ἀργύριον σύμμεικτον ἐπίσεμον* (line 301), etc.

The hoard evidence, though scanty and unsatisfactory, points in the same direction. Had the decree resulted in any large scale replacement of the currencies in daily use by Athenian coins, we should expect to find a much higher proportion of the latter in the hoards of the second half of the fifth century (and in the early fourth, for there is always a time-lag in such matters), whatever the political fortunes of the places where they were found. At Olynthos, which has been fully excavated, two, perhaps three, hoards, mostly consisting of small coins, fall within this period.[13] Between them, in addition to Chalcidian issues, they contain only one Athenian coin, as against 16 of Akanthos, 4 of Terone, 1 of Skione, 2 of Olynthos (before the Chal-

[11] Thucydides, VIII, 29.

[12] Thucydides, VIII, 101, with Gardner, *Hist. of Gk. Coinage*, p. 251, and Xenophon, *Hell.*, I, 6, 12.

[13] Robinson and Clement, *ibid.*, p. 161, Hoards V, VII; also VIII which I should guess was earlier than the date there given to it.

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cidian issues began), and 15 of Perdiccas. In the area generally, for the same period, S. P. Noe in his *Bibliography of Coin Hoards* (*Num. Notes and Mon.*, 78) gives the following silver hoards: Aidonochori (no. 23), Chalki (no. 234), Chios (no. 244), Euboea (no. 406), Kaliandra (nos. 521 and 522), Melos (no. 672), and Seres (no. 960).[14] The Euboea and Seres hoards consisted exclusively of Attic tetradrachms, but among the rest is only one Athenian coin, a triobol in the Chalki hoard.

It may be, indeed must be, that the proportion of Athenian to non-Athenian coins in circulation was considerably higher than appears from existing hoards; that this picture is in fact somewhat distorted, and would look different if we had more hoards from the heart of the *archê*, and more hoards containing the larger pieces. Otherwise with so many mints closed down, and so much, and such increasing, movement of persons and goods within the area, great inconvenience must have been caused. None the less it is obvious that owls were by no means the only silver coinage whose use among the cities was tolerated by Athens in the half century following the decree, and that, whatever the original intention, they came perforce in the end to supplement more than to replace. Where hoards *do* show Attic owls to have been very largely used, and put away, during this same period, is in the further Levant and Egypt.[15] It is possible that this steady draining away of Athenian silver outside the *archê* was not without effect in preventing that complete predominance within it originally aimed at by the decree.

E. S. G. Robinson

British Museum

[14] Mouchmov, *Bull. Soc. Arch. Bulgare*, IV, p. 274, no. 64. I assume his "second period" refers to the 5th century tetradrachms and not to the "new style."

[15] The Al Mina hoards (*N. Chr.*, 1937, p. 186 etc.), Maragh, Noe, *ibid.*, 647, and his numerous Egyptian hoards.

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